

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« That was a sprint-off. Every day I feel better and better. And defending the titles at the Europeans and Olympics? I think yes. — Jakob Ingebrigtsen after hurling himself over the line to snatch victory in the men's 1500m at the Oslo Diamond League »



« The amount of energy... It's difficult for me to talk. I don't know if it's gonna be the last time here in front of all of you. I'm not sure. But if it's the last time I enjoyed it. — Rafael Nadal after being knocked out of the French Open by Alexander Zverev in the first round »

9th

Gymnastics superstar Simone Biles won her ninth U.S. Championship recently, leaving little doubt that at 27 and a decade-plus into her run atop the sport, she is as good as ever. Biles posted a two-day all-around total of 119.750, nearly six points clear of runner-up Skye Blakely and leaving little doubt that she appears ready to add a second all-around Olympic gold to go with the one she captured in 2016. Biles finished with the highest two-day score on

all four events — something she'd done only once before at nationals (2018) — to build plenty of momentum ahead of the Olympic trials later in June in Minneapolis.



52.70s

Olympic champion Sydney McLaughlin-Levrone ramped up preparations for a title defence at this year's Paris Games by running a world-leading time of 52.70 seconds in her first 400 metres hurdles race in over a year. The 24-year-old displayed no signs of rust at the Edwin Moses Classic in Atlanta, as she effortlessly surged past her competitors to better Jamaican Rushell Clayton's previous season-leading mark of 53.72 by over a second.

CONTINUES TO IMPRESS



Sweden's Armand Duplantis failed in another attempt to break his pole vault world record but continued to impress ahead of the Paris Olympics at the Diamond League meet at Stockholm's Olympic Stadium. The Olympic and world champion broke his record for the eighth time with a vault of 6.24 metres in April, and after easing to victory with his first attempt at 6.00m, he had the home crowd behind him as he attempted to go even better. AP